Risk Resiliency Program
through
Cash for Training and Work
(RRP-CFTW)

Project LAWA and BINHI
(Local Adaptation to Water Access and Breaking Insufficiency through Nutritious Harvest for the Impoverished)

NARRATIVE REPORT AND PHOTO DOCUMENTATION

Submitted by:

BAROBO, SURIGAO DEL SUR

Republic of the Philippines
Province of Surigao Del Sur
Municipality of Lingig
MUNICIPAL SOCIAL WELFARE AND DEVELOPMENT OFFICE

NARRATIVE REPORT

RISK RESILIENCY PROGRAM
PROJECT LAWA AND BINHI
CY 2025

I. INTRODUCTION

The Province of Surigao del Sur is highly vulnerable to the adverse effects of climate change, faces increasing threats such as extreme weather events, prolonged drought and rising sea level. These environmental challenges have significantly impacted local communities particularly in terms of food security, water access and sustainable livelihood. The province particularly the barangays in the Municipalities of Barobo, Bayabas, Hinatuan, Lanuza and Lingig are among the areas with the highest number of poor families based on the DSWD Listahanan 3 and most likely exposed to the effects of El Niño and La Niña based on the Climate Outlook of DOST-PAGASA. Based on the PSA 2023 Full Year Official Poverty Statistics, the province recorded 20.1% poverty incidence. The data shows significant decrease compared to previous years. But these municipalities continue to have the highest number of poor families due to persistent unemployment and lack of sustainable livelihood opportunities. More so, many households struggled with insufficient access to water for consumption and agriculture, while small-scale farmers and fisherfolk experienced declining yields due to unpredictable weather patterns.

In order to address the issues and problems, the province continue to cope up with inevitability of disasters and climate change by ensuring that all programs and projects are implemented and managed effectively and efficiently.

Surigao del Sur's proactive steps in integrating environment sustainability with economic support like implementing the Project LAWA at BINHI through Cash for Training and Cash for Work initiatives aligns with national development goals, SDG 1 (Zero Poverty), 2 (Zero Hunger), SDG 13 (Climate Action), and SDG 17 (Partnerships for the goals), and Philippine Development Plan (PDP) – Supporting environmental protection and sustainable economic development. The province strongly supports this program in providing livelihood opportunities, particularly to local farmers, fisherfolks, and marginalized communities. Through this strong effort, in light of the immediate action to prevent deterioration of living conditions, Surigao del Sur effectively enhances the resilience of its communities, ensuring a more sustainable and secure future for its people.

Municipality of Barobo implemented Risk Resiliency Program (RRP) since 2018 from Climate Change Adaptation & Mitigation (CCAM) to Project LAWA & BINHI . This new modality is a community-based initiative designed to promote environmental sustainability, water resource management, and community resilience through localized action. "LAWA," which stands for "Local Action for Water Access," focuses on the sustainable use and protection of freshwater sources, while **"BREAKING INSUFFIENCY THROUGH NUTRITIOUS HARVEST FOR THE IMPOVERISHED (BINHI)"** in Filipino, highlights the importance of reforestation, biodiversity conservation, and environmental education.

This dual-purpose project integrates watershed protection, tree-growing activities, and community empowerment to address both ecological degradation and the socio-economic needs of vulnerable communities. By engaging local stakeholders—especially youth, farmers, and other sectoral groups —Project LAWA & BINHI fosters a sense of stewardship and shared responsibility for natural resources, helping to secure water availability and restore ecological balance for future generations.

Through this initiative, the project aims to build climate resilience, support livelihood development, and create a culture of environmental consciousness at the grassroots level.

RRP-CFTW's project LAWA at BINHI was part of the many programs of the DSWD which helps achieve its primary mandate to develop, implement, and coordinate social protection and poverty reduction solutions for and with the poor, vulnerable and disadvantaged.

II. HIGHLIGHTS OF ACCOMPLISHMENTS

A. Physical and Financial Accomplishments

The Project LAWA at BINHI was rolled out on March 17-19 & March 20-22,2025, following the formalization of the Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) between the DSWD Field Office Caraga and LGU of Barobo. The project covers 2 barangays across the municipality. These areas were identified as vulnerable and most likely exposed to the effects of El Niño and La Niña based on the Climate Outlook of DOST-PAGASA and were prioritized due to high poverty incidence, as reflected in the Listahanan 3 database of the National Household Targeting System for Poverty Reduction (NHTS-PR).

For FY 2025, the LGU of **Barobo** was allocated a total of **₱ 1,540,000.00 One Million and Five Hundred Forty Thousand** pesos by the DSWD Field Office Caraga in grants, intended as cash assistance for 200 partner beneficiaries.

With this amount, the LGU of **Barobo** provided a counterpart contribution of 45,000.00 allocated for **mobilization, training, logistics, monitoring, etc**. Table 1 shows the details of the LGU Counterpart.

Table 1. SUMMARY OF LGU COUNTERPART			
Budget Item	Fund Source	Amount	
		In Kind	In Cash
Planting Materials	Office of Municipal Agriculture	25,000.00	
Mobilization & Logistics	BLGU – Tambis & Bahi	15,000.00	
Fuel for Monitoring	MSWDO	5,000.00	
TOTAL		**45,000.00**	

As of April 22,2025, the LGU of Barobo, in partnership with DSWD Field Office Caraga, has successfully achieved **100%** accomplishment of both physical and financial targets. Table 2 presents the physical and financial accomplishments based on the output indicators set under the Risk Resiliency Program through Cash-for-Training and Work (RRP-CFTW).

Table 2. PHYSICAL AND FINANCIAL ACCOMPLISHMENTS (DSWD GRANTS)						
Barangay	Number of Partner Beneficiaries			Amount of Cash Assistance		
	Target	Actual	Accomplishment (%)	Target	Actual	Accomplishment (%)
Bahi	100	100	100%	100	100	100%
Tambis	100	100	100%	100	100	100%
TOTAL	**200**	**200**	**100%**	**200**	**200**	**100%**

B. Project Implementation Activities

1. Stage 1 – Cash-for-Training: Advancing Climate Action

To equip and prepare participants for the activities under Project LAWA at BINHI, the DSWD Field Office conducted a training and orientation session spearheaded by the **Municipal Social Welfare and Development Office** with the participation of 200 beneficiaries on **March 17-19,2025**, held at the Barangay Bahi Covered court and on March 20-22,2025 at Barangay Tambis Covered Court.

The cash-for-training for Stage 1 was implemented from **March 17,2025** to **March 22, 2025**, across the **2** barangays. DRMD personnel, as one of the resource speakers, discussed and introduced key topics on Disaster Risk Reduction Management (DRRM) and Climate Change Adaptation and Mitigation (CCAM). The beneficiaries gained a better understanding of these topics through scientific explanations of climate change, its impacts on communities, ecosystems, and agriculture, as well as practical strategies on how to effectively reduce risks, adapt to climate-related challenges, and implement sustainable practices at the community level. In addition, the requirements for the Risk Resiliency Program (RRP) documentary and frequently asked questions were thoroughly discussed.

To kickstart the implementation, a total of 5 training sessions was conducted, and the partner beneficiaries who attended, received a briefing and instructions on establishing Phase 1: Project LAWA and Phase 2: BINHI, including a step-by-step guide on how to commence the activities.

2. **Stage 2 – Cash-for-Work: Project Local Adaptation to Water Access (LAWA)**

The LGU of Barobo, in partnership with DSWD Field Office Caraga, has successfully implemented 2 projects under LAWA, achieving **100%** accomplishment. Project LAWA was established on March 24-April 9,2025 to prepare communities for the possible scarcity of water caused by the El Niño phenomenon, La Niña, and related climate impacts, aiming to ensure sustainable water access. 100 partner beneficiaries participated in **2** projects under Project LAWA. Table 3 summarizes the accomplishments of these projects.

Table 3. SUMMARY OF ACCOMPLISHMENTS FOR PROJECT LAWA			
Barangay	No. of LAWA Projects		Percentage of Accomplishment
	Target	Actual	
Bahi	1	1	100%
Tambis	1	1	100%
Total	**2**	**2**	**100%**

The LAWA projects in Caraga Region focused on::

- Construction of small farm reservoirs(SFR)
- Rehabilitation of Small Farm Reservoir(SFR
- Tilapia farming

3. **Stage 2 – Cash-for-Work: Project Breaking Insufficiency through Nutritious Harvest for the Impoverished (BINHI)**

Project BINHI was established on March 24-April 9,2025 to prepare communities for possible food scarcity caused by El Niño, La Niña, and other extreme weather events, ensuring food availability and security. 100 partner beneficiaries participated in **2** objects under Project BINHI. Table 4 summarizes the accomplishments of these projects.

Table 4. SUMMARY OF ACCOMPLISHMENTS FOR PROJECT BINHI			
Barangay	No. of BINHI Projects		Percentage of Accomplishment
	Target	Actual	
Bahi	2	2	100%
Tambis	3	3	100%
Total	**5**	**5**	**100%**

BINHI projects concentrated on:

- Fruit Tree Growing
- Lemon Farming
- Planting of Disaster Resilient Crops

These projects were collaboratively managed and sustained by local organizations and government units, ensuring community ownership and continuity.

4. **Stage 3 – Cash-for-Training: Sustainability Programming**

The cash-for-training for Stage 3 was implemented from April 7-8 **2025** in Barangay Bahi and April 8-9**,** 2025 in Barangay Tambis. A total of **5** training sessions was conducted, resulting in the formulation of **2** Community Action Plans (CAP). **Annex A** provides the details of CAP per barangay.

C. Project Output Analytics

1. **Project LAWA**

The 2 LAWA projects are expected to provide a total water capacity ranging from 500 to 1300 cubic meters, potentially supporting approximately 11,500 to 3,000 square meters or 4.35 hectares of agricultural land. **Annex B** provides detailed metrics of accomplishments and analytics for Project LAWA.

2. **Project BINHI**

The four (4) BINHI initiatives utilized approximately 1500 square meters of land for urban gardening, 1200 square meters of land planted with disaster-resilient crops, 20000 square meters of land for lemon farming which can yield roughly 34,000 to 90,000 kg of lemons annually, based on 112-400 trees/acre and 85-150 kg/tree yield. This converts to approximately 75 to 220 people who could be fed per kilogram of lemons. and 20,000 square meters of land planted with fruit -bearing trees, producing an estimated 5000-10000 kilograms. **Annex C** provides detailed metrics of accomplishments and analytics for Project BINHI.

D. Project Sustainability and Support

To ensure the long-term viability of **Project LAWA at BINHI**, various sustainability and support mechanisms were implemented by the partner beneficiaries, barangays, and the municipal government. These strategies were designed to maintain the functionality of the interventions, build local capacity, and foster community ownership. The following summarizes the key actions undertaken to support the continuity of the project:

1. **Project Functionality**

- Regular maintenance and timely repair of water access systems to ensure uninterrupted service and reliability.
- Continued production of high-yield crops through the use of climate-resilient and locally adapted crop varieties.
- Promotion and application of organic farming techniques, including crop rotation, composting, and the use of organic fertilizers, to sustain soil fertility and productivity.
- Establishment and maintenance of seed banks to secure a continuous and reliable supply of planting materials for future cycles.

2. **Community Involvement and Ownership**

- Organization and mobilization of partner-beneficiary groups at the barangay level to take active roles in project implementation and oversight.
- Formal turnover of project responsibilities to legally registered or recognized community groups, ensuring accountability and continuity.
- Designation of community project stewards who oversee the operation, monitoring, and upkeep of project components.

3. **Capacity Building and Technical Support**

- Implementation of regular capacity-building activities, including technical trainings on system operation, basic troubleshooting, and preventive maintenance.
- Deployment of local technical support teams and ongoing mentoring to address emerging needs and enhance self-reliance.

4. **Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning**

- Conduct of regular monitoring to assess the progress, continuity of the initiatives and functionality of the projects
- Use of participatory approaches such as focus group discussions, community feedback sessions, mentoring, and on-site technical assistance to gather insights and guide adaptive management.

5. **Financial Sustainability**

- Establishment of community-managed savings mechanisms or revolving funds to finance repairs, inputs, or emergency needs.
- Identification and strengthening of livelihood linkages, such as selling surplus produce or seedlings, to generate income and sustain agricultural efforts.

6. **Institutional Support, Partnerships and Advocacy**

- Integration of project strategies into local government planning, budgeting, and monitoring systems to ensure institutional continuity.

- Strengthened partnerships with municipal and barangay agriculture offices, water districts, nutrition councils, and other support agencies.

- Sharing of project success stories and lessons learned with local and national stakeholders to attract further support, partnerships, and scaling opportunities.

Table 5 presents the list of project end-users who officially accepted the turnover of Project LAWA at BINHI, along with the corresponding frequency of project monitoring in each barangay.

Table 5. LIST OF PROJECT END-USERS

Barangay	Project Name	Frequency of Monitoring	Project-End User	
			Group Name *(Do not abbreviate)*	Agency/Organized/ Registered
Bahi	*Lemon Farming* *Urban Gardening* *Tilapia Farming* *SFR*	*Twice a month* *Twice a month* *Daily* *Daily*	*Bahi Tree Farmers Association (BATFA)*	Registered
Tambis	*Fruit Tree Growing* *Lemon Farming* *Planting of Disaster Resilient Crops*	*Twice a month* *Twice a month* *Twicea month* *Daily*		

	Tilapia Farming *SFR*	*Daily*		

Table 6 presents the policy support provided for Project LAWA at BINHI by local government units, including enacted ordinances and passed resolutions that institutionalize or promote the sustainability of the projects.

Table 6. LIST OF POLICY SUPPORT				
Barangay	**Project Name**	**Local Support Policy**		**Description**
		No. of Ordinances Enacted	**No. of Resolutions Passed**	
N/A				
TOTAL				

E. *Innovations, Good Practices and Success Stories*

None

F. ***IEC Dissemination and Media Mileage***

None

G. Other Related Activities (training conducted/attended, advocacy activities, convergence strategies, etc.)

During the implementation of Stage 1: Cash-for-Training, additional relevant topics were incorporated into the standard DSWD training modules. These included the integration of various laws aimed at raising awareness and promoting the protection and welfare of vulnerable sectors. Table 8 provides the details of these related activities.

Table 8. TOPICS INTEGRATED DURING STAGE 1	
Law	**Description**
RA 9262	Anti-Violence Against Women and Their Children Act of 2004
RA 7610	Special Protection of Children Against Child Abuse, Exploitation and Discrimination Act
RA 9775	Anti-Child Pornography Act of 2009
RA 11313	Safe Spaces Act or "Bawal Bastos" Law
RA 9344	Juvenile Justice and Welfare Act (as amended by RA 10630)
RA 10821	Children's Emergency Relief and Protection Act
RA 8353	Anti-Rape Law of 1997
RA 8749 RA 9003	Environmental Protection, Conservation, Policy and Programs

In addition to discussions on health and safety protocols, training sessions also covered the following topics:

- Seedling Propagation and Nursery Establishment
- Pond Management and Tilapia Farming

Moreover, DOLE personnel, including Public Employment Service Office (PESO) Managers from Provincial Satellite Offices, were tapped during the Stage 3 implementation to conduct orientations on the registration of Rural Workers' Associations.

III. CHALLENGES AND RECOMMENDATIONS

- Identification of recipient barangays and beneficiaries form provincial and barangay level
- Location and area of project site
- Operation and maintenance for the project BINHI and LAWA
- Willingness and commitment of group association for the continuity and sustainability
- Budget allocation at barangay & municipal level
- Insufficient tools & equipment for tree planting & clean-up
- The maintenance of works for Barangay Bahi was turn-over to Bahi Tree Farmers Association (BATFA)
- Delayed of implementation of LAWA due to limited supply of fingerlings and germination of seeds.

IV. WAYS FORWARD

- That the municipal down to barangay level will allocate funds for the maintenance and sustainability
- The association / barangay will ensure that they are responsible to protect and supervise the project
- Continuous advocacy and programs on the disaster related and climate change mitigation responsive projects
- To be one of the recipient barangays of the next year engagement of LAWA & BINHI Implementation
- Partnership and coordination among PLGU, MLGU, BLGU, community and partner beneficiaries

V. ANNEXES

All the following annexes have been compiled and uploaded to the google drive:

A. Signed and Accomplished Community Action Plans (CAPs) of Partner Beneficiaries
B. Accomplished Monitoring, Evaluation, and Reporting (MER) Tool for Project LAWA
C. Accomplished Monitoring, Evaluation, and Reporting (MER) Tool for Project BINHI
D. Photocopies of Registration Documents of Organized Groups or Project End-Users
E. Photocopies of Resolutions Passed and Ordinances Enacted
F. Notarized Binding Agreements on Lot Utilization (e.g., Resolution, Memorandum of Agreement or MOA, Usufruct Agreement)
G. Photo and Video Documentation/Compilation

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MLGU Focal	Municipal Mayor

CASH-FOR-TRAINING
Stage 1 – Advancing Climate Action
Learning Development Session

Left:MENRO Staff of LGU Barobo discussed about Environmental Protection, Conservation, Policy and Programs

Middle: Darwin B. Patriarca, Agriculture Technician II discussed Module 3 Seesion 3: Project LAWA at BINHI:Community vegetable Gardening and Planting of Fruit-Bearing Trees and Lemon Farming in Barangay Bahi

Right:Dianne Rose B. Layno,SWO III oriented the partner-beneficiaries regarding Protection Laws for Women and Children.

Below: Aquaculturists Jamil Sarip and Vincent P. Escosa discussed Proper Pond Management and Tilapia Farming.

RRP PLGU Focal, Tonton G. Macapala, PDO I highlighted the importance of the projects to the communities.

CASH-FOR-TRAINING
Stage 3 – Sustainability Programming
Learning Development Session

Partner-beneficiaries of Barangay Bahi and Tambis participated the Community Action Planning during the Stage 3 Cash-for-Training Sustainability Programming Workshops

CASH-FOR-TRAINING
Stage 3 – Sustainability Programming
Turnover Ceremony

Photos were taken during the Turn-over Ceremony of Project LAWA at BINHI to Baranagay Bahi and Tambis

CASH-FOR-WORK
Phase 1: Establishment of Project LAWA

The Construction of Small Farm Reservoir (SFR) and in Barangay Bahi and Tambis

CASH-FOR-WORK
Phase 2: Establishment of Project BINHI

During CASH-FOR-WORK:Clearing and cleaning of BINHI sites and cultivation of land and planting of Lemon Trees in Barangay Bahi(above) and Barangay Tambis (below)